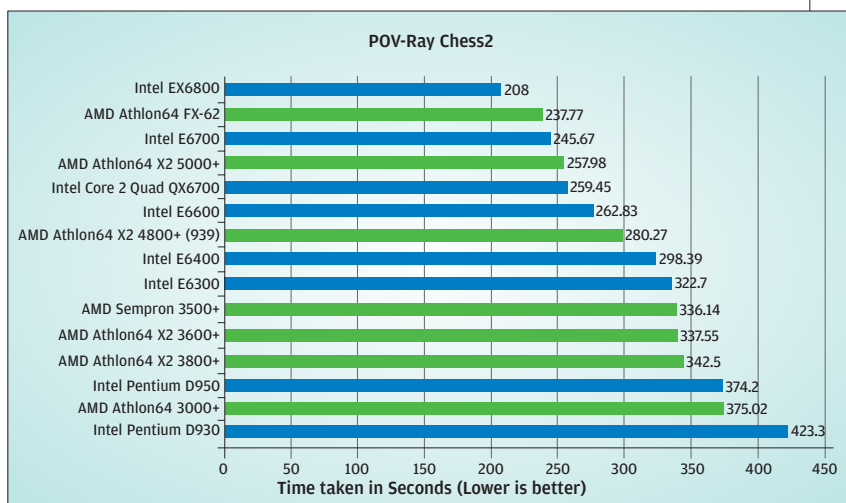


POV-Ray 3.6

Raytracing is one of the most mathematically intensive operations a processor can perform—the process involves casting rays of light from a virtual “camera” on to the 3D scene and calculating their paths. As seen from the graph, the EX6800 renders the image in the shortest possible time. The AMD FX-62 breaks into second place—no surprises; AMD processors have been known for great ALU performance, which really counts in raytracing. The Athlon64 X2 5000+ comes in at third place ahead of the Quad Core—proving again that the QX6700 requires optimisation to perform.

Conclusion

Intel is right at the top with its Core architecture based CPUs. Most of the professional 3D tools have already migrated to multi-threaded environments, and that's good news because the Quad Core shines here. Though we have just tested the Quad Core with CineBench this time, we will definitely be putting it through

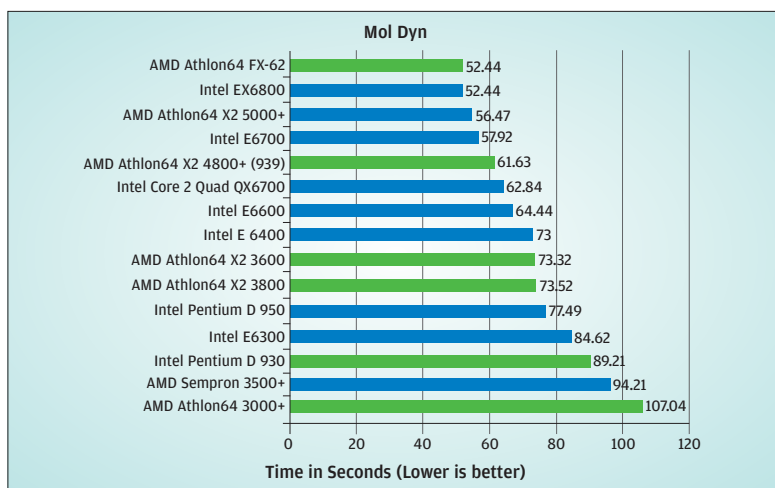
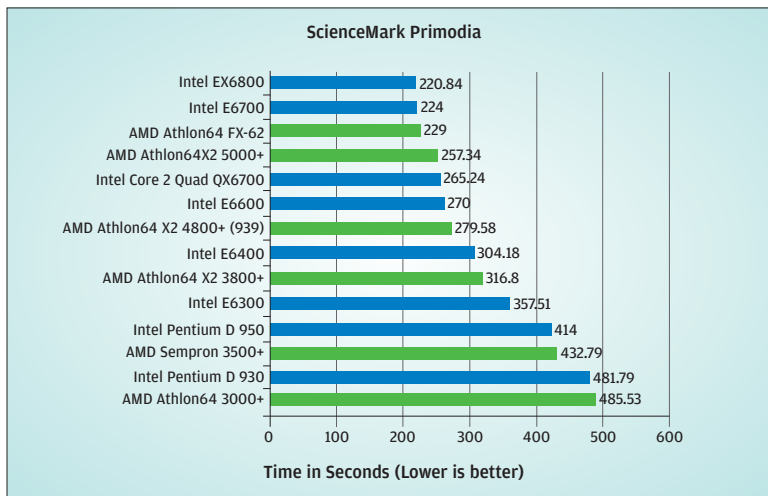


rigorous 3D rendering tests in the coming months. Right now, Quad Core just relishes multi-threaded applications, boosting their performance to levels never before seen on desktops.

Number-crunching Tests

ScienceMark 2.0 Primordia

Here the EX6800 was on the top of the chart followed by its lower-clocked sibling, the E6700. AMD's FX-62 managed to get in the third spot followed by the Athlon64 X2 5000+. These figures are quite similar to what we saw in the last test too. AMD processors generally do better in scientific tests—scientific calculations generally involve iterations, and the shorter pipeline and highly optimised cache offer a better performance when running loops.



ScienceMark 2.0 Mol Dyn:

Again, the AMD FX-62 shows its dominance in this test, matching the Core 2 EX6800. The Athlon64 X2 5000+ comes in at third spot. The Quad Core is completely left out—this might have to do with its thirst for multi-threaded applications. The other AMD Athlon64 X2 processors are on par with the respective Core 2 Duo performances.